

Why the meal-plan idea could help

This document connects the interview findings to the original meal-plan project and its business objective.

What we wanted to learn

The team wanted to find out whether students would be more interested in buying a campus meal plan if it was flexible and gave them better value for their money.

Students described different budgets and eating habits. The project therefore focused on a meal-plan idea that could work for students who ate on campus often and for students who ate there only sometimes.

How student needs led to the idea

- Students judged a plan by its cost, flexibility, food choices, eligible locations, and rules for unused value.
- A single fixed structure did not match the different spending and eating patterns described in the interviews.
- The team proposed multiple plan structures, rollover, and payment choices for further validation.
- If later research supported the idea, a flexible plan could interest more students and keep more student dining spending on campus.

What we still did not know

The interviews supported testing the idea. They did not establish exact prices, prove that rollover or monthly payments were operationally possible, or confirm that vendors would participate. Those questions stayed outside the first phase.